

# BUILDING BLOCKS — Part 2

Problems of Tribal Communities | Anthropology Paper 2 | Quick Revision

**Format:** Each block = standard content (Scholar + Case Study + Data + Quotable + Use in) followed by a memory aid (mnemonic / flow diagram / hook). Learn 14 blocks → answer any tribal problems question.

## LAND ALIENATION (Blocks 1-3)

### BLOCK 1 — Land = Identity

Land alienation / Root cause / Tribal unrest

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scholar    |  <b>L.P. Vidyarthi</b> — "Land alienation is root cause of all tribal unrest"<br> <b>Dhebar Commission</b> — "Loss of land = loss of livelihood, dignity, identity" |
| Case Study | <b>Koraput, Odisha</b> — tribal landholdings fell over 50% between 1970-1990 (Xaxa, 2001)<br><b>Khuntkatti</b> (Mundas) and <b>Bhuinhari</b> (Oraons) — collective ownership systems collapsed                                                                                                                                        |
| Data       | <b>50% land loss in 20 years</b> (Koraput); land = economic resource + social identity + cultural continuity + ecological survival                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Quotable   | <i>"Land is not merely an economic resource — it is the basis of social identity, cultural continuity, and ecological survival"</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

**Use in:** Land alienation, tribal unrest, displacement, cultural erosion, tribal identity, forest rights, development critique

#### MEMORY AID

#### L. D. K. — "Land Defines Kabilas (tribes)"

- L** L.P. Vidyarthi — Land = root of all unrest
- D** Dhebar — land loss = dignity loss
- K** Koraput — 50% gone; Khuntkatti collapsed

### BLOCK 2 — Development = Displacement

Dams / Mining / Resistance / Co-existence

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scholar    |  <b>Walter Fernandes</b> — links displacement to development-induced impoverishment                                                                                   |
| Case Study | <b>Narmada Valley</b> — 2 lakh displaced, majority Adivasis, Narmada Bachao Andolan (1985)<br><b>Kanha Tiger Reserve (2014)</b> — 450 Baiga/Gond families evicted<br><b>Soliga (Biligirirangana Hills)</b> — allowed to stay, tiger population increased |
| Data       | <b>Narmada: 30 major + 135 medium + 3,000 small dams</b> ; Karanpura: 75,000 ha acquired in Jharkhand                                                                                                                                                    |
| Quotable   | <i>"Displacement is not development — it is impoverishment with a different name"</i>                                                                                                                                                                    |

**Use in:** Displacement, R&R, dams, mining, tribal resistance, environment vs development, FRA, LARR Act, national parks, co-existence models

#### MEMORY AID

#### Fernandes warns: Dam → Displaced → Deprived

#### 3 cases, 3 outcomes:

Narmada = mass displacement (2 lakh) | Kanha = eviction (450 families) | Soliga = co-existence (tigers increased)

Remember: "NKS" — Narmada Kicked, Soliga Stayed

### BLOCK 3 — Class Within Tribe

Internal stratification / Moneylender exploitation

|            |                                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scholar    |  <b>B.K. Roy Burman</b> — class differentiation within the tribe after land alienation |
| Case Study | <b>Tharu &amp; Bhoksa (U.P.)</b> — post-Partition refugee moneylenders offered loans, grabbed land through fraudulent contracts                                         |
| Data       | New landlord tribals emerge; others become <b>dependent labourers</b> — traditional egalitarianism breaks                                                               |
| Quotable   | <i>"Alienation creates two classes within the tribe — the new landlord and the new labourer"</i>                                                                        |

**Use in:** Social stratification, tribal egalitarianism breakdown, moneylender exploitation, land consequences, class formation in tribes

#### MEMORY AID

**Roy Burman = "Roy" (king) vs "Burman" (common)**

Land alienation splits tribe into **kings** (new landlords) and **commons** (labourers)

Case: *Tharu* — *Tricked by moneylenders*

## WOMEN & DISPLACEMENT (Block 4)

### BLOCK 4 — Women Bear the Worst

Gender / Land rights / Health / Trafficking

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scholar    | <b>NFHS-5</b> — 60% ST women anaemic; maternal mortality 167 per lakh (higher than national avg)<br><b>Xaxa Committee (2014)</b> — early marriage and chores reduce girls' schooling                                                                      |
| Case Study | <b>Polavaram Dam (A.P.)</b> — female-headed households least compensated, most food insecure<br><b>Baiga/Gond women (M.P.)</b> — once managed Bewar fields, now daily wage labour<br><b>Santhal women</b> — 12+ hour workdays (ICSSR); eat last and least |
| Data       | <b>60% anaemic, 167 maternal mortality, 12+ hr workday</b> ; women eat last, compensated last                                                                                                                                                             |
| Quotable   | <i>"Displacement is negotiated with men — women are left without ownership or compensation"</i>                                                                                                                                                           |

**Use in:** Tribal women, gender & displacement, women's autonomy, land rights, nutrition, maternal health, trafficking — ANY "impact on women" question

#### MEMORY AID

**Women: LAST in everything**

**Last to eat | Last to be compensated | Last to be consulted**

3 cases: *Polavaram* = no compensation, *Baiga* = field to wage, *Santhal* = 12hr day

"PBS" — *Polavaram, Baiga, Santhal*

## POVERTY (Blocks 5-6)

### BLOCK 5 — Five Stairs Down

B.D. Sharma's framework / Structural deprivation / Poverty cascade

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scholar    |  <b>B.D. Sharma</b> — Five Levels of Deprivation: (1) Rights denied (2) Means lost (3) Wages cheated (4) Liberty sold (5) Spirit broken |
| Case Study | <b>Adivasi tea workers (Assam)</b> — earn less than non-tribals for same work (Level 3)<br><b>Tribal women in Jharkhand/Odisha</b> — trafficked due to poverty (Level 4)                                                 |
| Data       | <b>STs BPL: rural 45.3%, urban 24.1% (2011-12)</b> — poorest among all groups; declined from 62.3% (2004-05) but still worst                                                                                             |
| Quotable   | <i>"Tribals are not poor by culture, but made poor by circumstance"</i>                                                                                                                                                  |

**Use in:** Tribal poverty, structural exclusion, bonded labour, trafficking, deprivation framework, multi-dimensional poverty — this framework structures ANY poverty answer

#### MEMORY AID

**R - M - W - L - S "Rights, Means, Wages, Liberty, Spirit"**

**Rights denied → Means lost → Wages cheated → Liberty sold → Spirit broken**

*Think of it as a person falling 5 stairs — each step causes the next*

**Forest taken → Becomes labourer → Paid half → Daughter trafficked → Gives up fighting**

### BLOCK 6 — Ecological Dislocation

Root cause of poverty / Colonial legacy / Forest loss

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scholar    |  <b>D.N. Majumdar</b> — "tribal poverty is not merely economic but an outcome of dislocation from the ecological niche"<br> <b>B.D. Sharma</b> — "the tribal world is being impoverished in the name of development" |
| Case Study | <b>Saharias (Kuno, M.P.)</b> — Asmita Kabra (2009): 80% lived below poverty line after losing forest produce access post-relocation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Data       | <b>80% BPL after relocation</b> ; India's growth (Green Revolution, industrialisation, urbanisation) bypassed subsistence tribal economy                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Quotable   | <i>"The tribal world is being impoverished in the name of development"</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

**Use in:** Root causes of poverty, ecological displacement, colonial legacy, forest policy, MFP loss, national parks displacement, development critique

#### MEMORY AID

**Majumdar = "M" = Mismatch** — tribe dislocated from its ecological niche

**Saharia = "S" = Severed** — 80% BPL after being severed from forest

*Poverty = not lack of money, but loss of ecosystem*

## INDEBTEDNESS (Blocks 7-8)

### BLOCK 7 — Barter to Bondage

Monetisation / Moneylenders / Bonded labour

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scholar    |  <b>Christoph von Fürer-Haimendorf</b> — shift from barter to monetised economy exposed tribals to moneylenders<br> <b>Rangarajan</b> — 36% of ST farmer households indebted to non-institutional sources |
| Case Study | <b>Sahariya (Baran, Rajasthan)</b> — Hali system of bonded labour despite Abolition Act 1976<br><b>Juang PVTG (Odisha)</b> — Goti system binds families into labour for generations                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Data       | <b>36% ST farmers indebted</b> ; mostly to non-institutional sources (moneylenders, traders)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Quotable   | <i>"Good laws, bad implementation — true catharsis occurs only when policy translates into freedom from debt, bondage, and indignity"</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

**Use in:** Indebtedness, bonded labour, monetisation impact, moneylender exploitation, colonial economic legacy, PVTGs, legislative failure

#### MEMORY AID

**Barter → Money → Moneylender → Bondage**

**Fürer-Haimendorf** = "the Foreign scholar who saw the Fall from barter to bondage"

Two **bonded labour systems**: Hali (Sahariya) + Goti (Juang) = "**HG**"

*36% indebted — "more than 1 in 3 tribal farmers in debt"*

### BLOCK 8 — Debt Destroys Families

Trafficking / Health impacts / Bonded labour persists

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scholar    |  <b>Anumeha Yadav</b> — Goti bonded labour persists despite laws<br> <b>V.G. Rao</b> — 36.5% STD prevalence among tribal villagers (Jabalpur study) |
| Case Study | <b>Bedia community</b> — women pushed into prostitution as debt-repayment<br><b>Ho &amp; Munda women (Jharkhand/Odisha)</b> — sent as domestic servants through exploitative networks                                                                                                                                     |
| Data       | <b>Bonded Labour Act 1976 + Orissa Debt Act 1948</b> — both widely violated in practice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Quotable   | <i>"Indebtedness is both a cause and a consequence of underdevelopment"</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

**Use in:** Indebtedness consequences, human trafficking, bonded labour, tribal women, health impacts, legislative failure, migration & exploitation

#### MEMORY AID

**Debt → 3 D's: Domestic slavery (Ho/Munda) | Degradation (Bedia) | Disease (V.G. Rao - 36.5%)**

*Two Acts, both fail: 1976 (Bonded Labour) + 1948 (Orissa Debt) = "laws on paper, bondage on ground"*

## EDUCATION (Blocks 9-10)

### BLOCK 9 — Education of the Forest

Language barrier / Cultural alienation / Dropout

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scholar    |  <b>Verrier Elwin</b> — "Education must be of the forest and not against the forest"<br>"Let us teach the tribe not to despise his culture, but to enrich it through knowledge" |
| Case Study | <b>Gonds (M.P.)</b> — Hindi-medium education culturally alien, difficult to relate<br><b>Chenchu/Konda Reddi PVTGs (A.P.)</b> — girls leave after Class V, no female teachers or hostels                                                                         |
| Data       | <b>ST literacy 59% vs national 73%</b> (Census 2011); ST female below 50%; gender gap nearly 20 points;<br>Mizoram highest (91.6%), A.P. lowest (49.2%)                                                                                                          |
| Quotable   | <i>"Curriculum and language of instruction are alien to tribal worldview — schools alienate rather than empower"</i>                                                                                                                                             |

**Use in:** Tribal education, language barrier, dropout, cultural alienation, girls' education, NEP 2020, bilingual education, EMRS, Article 350A

#### MEMORY AID

**Elwin = "E" = Education OF forest, not AGAINST forest**

**59 vs 73** — remember as "ST literacy is 14 behind"

Two extremes: **Mizoram = Miraculous (91.6%)** | **A.P. = Awful (49.2%)**

### BLOCK 10 — Elite Capture

Education consequences / Tribal elite / Institutional abuse

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scholar    | <b>S.C. Dube (1955)</b> — educated intermediaries form tribal elite serving self-interest<br><b>Xaxa Committee (2014)</b> — early marriage and household chores reduce girls' schooling |
| Case Study | <b>Maharashtra</b> — 29 tribal girls exploited in hostels (2011-2016)<br><b>Muzaffarpur shelter case</b> — abuse in residential institutions                                            |
| Data       | <b>ST male 68.5% vs female below 50%</b> — nearly 20-point gender gap in literacy                                                                                                       |
| Quotable   | <i>"Education creates tribal elites who serve self-interest rather than community welfare"</i>                                                                                          |

**Use in:** Education consequences, tribal leadership, gender disparity, safety in institutions, Xaxa Committee, elite formation, women's education

#### MEMORY AID

**Dube = "D" for Double-edged** — education empowers some, creates elite who exploit others

**Xaxa = "X" marks the problem** — early marriage kills girls' education

68 vs 50 — "men 68, women can't even reach 50"

## UNEMPLOYMENT (Blocks 11-12)

### BLOCK 11 — Quitting Farming, No Alternative

Informal economy / Reservation vacant / Skill gap

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scholar    |  <b>Richard Mahapatra</b> — "tribals quitting farming fast, every second household in informal economy"<br> <b>Saiyed Zegham Murtaza</b> — "extreme disregard of reservation norms" |
| Case Study | <b>112th Parliamentary Standing Committee (2023)</b> — 1,199 of 3,097 ST-reserved posts in 45 central universities remain vacant; over 3,000 in ministries                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Data       | <b>75% in agriculture</b> (subsistence); only <b>4.8% in regular/salaried jobs</b> ; less than 2% formally skilled                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Quotable   | <i>"These figures betray an extreme disregard of the reservation norms"</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

**Use in:** Tribal unemployment, reservation failure, informal economy, skill gap, distress migration, agricultural crisis, governance failure

#### MEMORY AID

**75 - 5 - 2 rule:** 75% in farming | only 5% salaried | only 2% skilled  
**Mahapatra = "M" for Mass exodus from farming**  
**Murtaza = "M" for Missing reservation** — 1,199 posts vacant in universities  
*"Two M's complaining: one about farming, one about jobs"*

### BLOCK 12 — Jobless to Extremist

Naxalism / Seasonal unemployment / Migration

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scholar    |  <b>Bhatia</b> — studies in Bastar link unemployment with Naxal recruitment<br> <b>N.C. Saxena</b> — agriculture and forest work limited to 4-5 months, rest casual labour |
| Case Study | <b>Bastar</b> — 70% of employed tribal women = seasonal MGNREGA labourers, earn less than men<br><b>Jharkhand/Odisha</b> — mass migration to brick kilns in A.P., factories in Surat/Mumbai                                                                                                                                                     |
| Data       | <b>MGNREGA: ST share dropped from 36% to 17-20%</b> ; STs form 20% of workers (twice their population share)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Quotable   | <i>"Joblessness fuels frustration, alcoholism, and susceptibility to extremism"</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

**Use in:** Naxalism/LWE, unemployment consequences, seasonal work, distress migration, MGNREGA critique, Bastar, extremism root causes

#### MEMORY AID

**4 months work → 8 months idle → Migration or Naxalism**  
**Bhatia = Bastar = Bombs** (unemployment → Naxalism)  
**Saxena = Seasonal** (4-5 months work only)  
**MGNREGA: "36 to 17"** — tribal participation halved

## HEALTH & NUTRITION (Blocks 13-14)

### BLOCK 13 — Prosperity Without Well-being

Health paradox / Mining wealth / Triple disease burden

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scholar    | <b>Abhay Bang Committee (2018)</b> — tribal India faces <b>triple burden</b> : communicable diseases + NCDs + mental health                                                     |
| Case Study | <b>Keonjhar, Odisha</b> — 26% of India's iron ore, ₹15,000 crore in mineral funds, yet worst child/maternal health; 74.7% pregnant women anaemic; villages 20+ km from hospital |
| Data       | <b>STs: 30% of malaria cases, 60% of P. falciparum, 50% of malaria deaths</b><br>TB: 703 vs 256 per lakh nationally; life expectancy 63.9 vs 67 years; 45% children stunted     |
| Quotable   | <i>"A paradox of prosperity without well-being — extractive wealth flows out while health deprivation stays"</i>                                                                |

**Use in:** Tribal health, mining impact, resource curse, health infrastructure, malaria/TB, malnutrition, maternal health, development critique

#### MEMORY AID

**Triple burden = CMD: Communicable + Mental + Developmental (NCDs)**

**Keonjhar paradox:** "richest soil, sickest people" — **26% iron ore, 74% anaemic mothers**

**Malaria: 30-60-50 rule** — 30% cases, 60% falciparum, 50% deaths

*"Bang" Committee — the name itself says "wake up!"*

### BLOCK 14 — Gadchiroli Solution

Community health / Traditional medicine / Success model

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scholar    |  <b>P.C. Joshi</b> — integration of ethnomedicine with PHCs could improve outcomes<br><b>Dr. Abhay &amp; Rani Bang</b> — SEARCH initiative in Gadchiroli |
| Case Study | <b>Gadchiroli, Maharashtra</b> — SEARCH trained village health workers for home-based newborn care → reduced neonatal mortality<br>Formula: community participation + local training + traditional integration                              |
| Data       | <b>PHC shortfall: 27-40%</b> in tribal areas; 33% shortage of doctors; 45% tribal children stunted (NFHS-5)                                                                                                                                 |
| Quotable   | <i>"Tribal health is a test of India's commitment to equity" — Abhay Bang Committee</i>                                                                                                                                                     |

**Use in:** Health solutions, community participation, AYUSH integration, traditional medicine, way forward for ANY health question, NHM, decentralised planning, success stories

#### MEMORY AID

**SEARCH = Solution:** train locals, trust tradition, treat at home

**P.C. Joshi = "P" for PHC + ethnomedicine Partnership**

**Gadchiroli = the ONE success story** — always use in "way forward"

*"Bang solved it, Joshi theorised it" — use both together*

## BLOCK COMBINATIONS — "If UPSC asks about X, pick these"

| Question Theme     | Blocks       | Must-drop scholar       | Must-use case             |
|--------------------|--------------|-------------------------|---------------------------|
| Land alienation    | B1 + B2 + B3 | L.P. Vidyarthi, Dhebar  | Koraput, Narmada          |
| Displacement / R&R | B2 + B4 + B6 | Walter Fernandes, Kabra | Narmada, Saharias, Soliga |

|                                     |                    |                             |                                        |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>Tribal women / gender</b>        | B4 + B8 + B9       | NFHS-5, Xaxa                | Polavaram, Bedia, Chenchu              |
| <b>Poverty / deprivation</b>        | B5 + B6 + B7       | B.D. Sharma, Majumdar       | Assam tea, Saharias                    |
| <b>Indebtedness / bonded labour</b> | B7 + B8 + B3       | Fürer-Haimendorf, Yadav     | Sahariya-Hali, Juang-Goti              |
| <b>Education</b>                    | B9 + B10 + B4      | Verrier Elwin, Xaxa         | Gonds, KISS Odisha                     |
| <b>Unemployment / Naxalism</b>      | B11 + B12 + B5     | Mahapatra, Bhatia           | Bastar, MGNREGA data                   |
| <b>Health / nutrition</b>           | B13 + B14 + B6     | Abhay Bang, P.C. Joshi      | Keonjhar, Gadchiroli                   |
| <b>Development critique</b>         | B2 + B5 + B6 + B13 | Sharma, Fernandes, Majumdar | Keonjhar, Narmada, Saharias            |
| <b>Impact on women (any topic)</b>  | B4 + B8 + B10      | NFHS-5, Anumeha Yadav       | Polavaram, Bedia, Maharashtra          |
| <b>Legislative failure</b>          | B7 + B8 + B11      | Murtaza, Anumeha Yadav      | Hali + Goti persist, 1199 vacant posts |
| <b>Way forward / solutions</b>      | B14 + B5 + B9      | Bang, Elwin, Sharma         | Gadchiroli, EMRS, FRA                  |